GRADE 4

Curriculum Book

Businesses need a simple plan

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 4 - Curriculum Book

Five questions, one page, one plan. Make the idea move. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Welcome to Cash to Company, Grade 4. *This year your child is learning how to make a simple plan for a small business. Not a real business — a plan that fits on one page. The work is real, but the stakes are classroom-sized.*

The mascot is Cash, a friendly coin-shaped character who appears in eight short videos across the year. Cash is curious, calm, and never promises that anyone will get rich. Cash asks questions that point your child toward evidence: *Who, exactly, is this for? How do you know? What's one number you could check?*

You don't need to teach this at home. You don't need to be an expert. Below are four light ways to support your child this year.

Five answers, one page

The whole plan fits on one sheet of paper.

What your child will do this year

> *"A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one."*
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 4**

The year is built around one project: the One-Page Plan. Across 36 weeks, your child will:

1. **Read a real business and summarize it in 3–5 sentences.** (Unit 1, fall)
2. **Pick their own business idea and run it through a 5-question Reality Check.** (Unit 2, late fall)
3. **Build a $50 budget for a classroom event with at least 4 categories.** (Unit 3, winter)
4. **Write the One-Page Plan, revise it, and defend it in 4 minutes to a small panel.** (Unit 4, spring)

The "panel" for the spring defense is usually 2–4 adults: other teachers, parents, or community members. If you'd like to be on the panel, ask your teacher in March.

What your child will NOT do this year

TRY THIS

One question, five people

Pick the customer question from your one-page plan. Ask five real people in one day. Write each answer in one sentence.

- **No questions about family money.** Your child will never be asked how much your family spends, earns, or owes. Cash to Company is built on a strict rule: family money is private. The $50 budget is for a hypothetical classroom event, not a household budget.
- **No "you can be a millionaire" promises.** Cash to Company doesn't promise wealth or success. The promise is that your child will be a clearer thinker about money and ideas, no matter what they end up doing.
- **No selling things to other kids without your permission.** If your child wants to actually run their business idea outside the classroom, the curriculum requires adult permission. We'll never put your child in a position where they're selling without your okay.

One good question per quarter

WORDS TO KNOW

Plan
Five honest answers about how a business works.

Customer
The exact person you can name and describe.

Offer
What the customer gets, in plain words.

Pricing
What the customer pays, and why that number.

Test
The smallest real thing you can do to see if the plan works.

You don't have to lead a finance class at home. One good question — once a quarter — does more than a daily lecture.

Quarter 1 (Unit 1) — early fall

> CASH SAYS
>
> "*Tell me about the business profile you read at school. What does that business do?*"

Listen. Your child will probably summarize it imperfectly — that's fine. They're practicing. If they read about a bakery, ask: "*Who do you think buys most of their bread?*" That's the year's spine question, in plain words.

Quarter 2 (Unit 2) — late fall / early winter

> CASH SAYS
>
> "*What's your Capstone idea? Who's the first person who'd actually buy it?*"

The "first person" framing is gold. It pushes past "*everyone will love it*" toward someone real. If your child names a specific friend, neighbor, or schoolmate — the work is going well. If they say "everyone" — gently ask "*Could you point to one person?*"

Quarter 3 (Unit 3) — late winter

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*You're working on a $50 budget for a class event. What did you have to leave out?*"

Every budget is a trade-off. Your child has to cut something to fit under $50. The cut is the lesson, not the spending.

Quarter 4 (Unit 4) — spring

> **CASH SAYS**
>
> "*What changed between the first version of your plan and the last version? Why?*"

Revision is the hardest skill of the year. If your child can name three changes with reasons — they have done the work. If they can't, the question itself is a useful nudge.

What to watch for

> **MATH MOMENT**
>
> **How many a week?**
>
> If you sold 3 a day for 5 days, how many is that? If each one costs $2 to make and sells for $5, what's left?

A good sign

Your child says something specific they didn't say a month ago. "*My customer is third graders who play kickball at recess.*" Or "*My cost per friendship bracelet is 30 cents.*" Or "*I changed my price because the math didn't work.*" That kind of specificity is the year's main outcome.

A signal to check in

Your child says they "can't think of a business idea" three weeks in a row. Some students freeze on Day 1. The teacher has tools for this — let them know. The fix is usually not at home.

A signal that's not a problem

Your child changes their Capstone idea in Week 9 or Week 19. The curriculum has built-in pivot windows for exactly this. Pivoting based on what they learned is *evidence-driven*, which is the whole game. Cash's frame: "*Pivoting is not failing. Pivoting is paying attention.*"

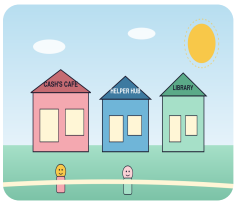
A sensitivity flag

If your child mentions the $50 budget activity feels uncomfortable — for any reason — let the teacher know. We have an alternative event topic available, and the team will swap quietly.

How you can help (lightly)

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real answers

Read each plan answer to a different person. Write what they say back, exactly. That's data.

You don't have to do anything. But if you want to, here are three low-effort moves:

1. **Ask the question.** Once a quarter is plenty.
2. **Let your child read aloud.** When they bring home their One-Page Plan, ask them to read it to you. Just listen. Don't correct.
3. **If your child wants to interview a real customer.** Some students will want to ask a neighbor, a relative, or a family friend a question or two about a product. Help them set it up. The script is short — "*Tell me about the last time you ____. What was annoying about it?*" — and the conversation usually takes 3–5 minutes.

A note on Cash

FAMILY TALK

Five honest answers

Read your one-page plan to a family member. Ask: 'Which answer sounds the least real to you, and why?' Listen, don't defend.

Cash is the program's mascot — a coin-shaped, gender-neutral animated character who appears in eight short videos across the year. Cash is friendly but not babyish. Cash never says "*easy money*" or "*anyone can be a millionaire.*" Cash asks evidence questions and tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.

If you watch one of the Cash videos with your child, here's what you'll see: a calm character with a small notebook asking real questions about a small business idea. The videos are short (under three minutes each) and end with a classroom assignment, not a sales pitch.

End of year

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

In late May or early June, your child will defend their One-Page Plan in front of a small panel. You may be invited to attend or to serve on the panel. If you do attend, the panel rule is the same one Cash uses: *be curious, not a critic.* You're not deciding whether the business would "really work." You're noticing how clearly the student thought about it.

The biggest moment of the year is when your child compares their Day 1 idea card (written in Week 1) to their final One-Page Plan. The plan will be sharper, more specific, and more honest. The card will probably look small. That's the point.

Questions?

The teacher is your first stop. The full Curriculum Book and Lesson Plans are also available — ask if you'd like to read them.

Cash to Company makes one promise: that your child will be a clearer thinker about money and ideas no matter what they end up doing for a living. We don't promise wealth. We don't promise success. We promise clarity. That's it.

Thank you for sharing your child with the program this year.

— The Cash to Company team

Senior expert upgrade pack — Sample dialogue if your kid wants a real $50 birthday party

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

If your Grade 4 child comes home and says "*I want to throw a birthday party with $50, just like the school project,*" here's a script that honors both the curriculum and your family's reality:

You: "*Cool — that's a real plan. Tell me your four categories.*"

Child: *(may struggle to break it down — that's the lesson)*

You: "*What's the food, what's the activity, what's the decorations, what's the favors?*"

Child: *(answers; may overrun)*

You: "*That's $63. We're $13 over. What can we cut?*"

Child: *(picks something to cut)*

You: "*Now you have a real budget. Let's see what really happens.*"

This is exactly the Grade 4 lesson, applied at home. You don't need to teach. You need to ask the four-category question and the "what can we cut?" question.

If $50 isn't realistic for your family right now, that's fine. The exercise still works at any number — including $0 (a free party). The skill is the planning, not the spending.

Other one-question prompts

- "*What's a plan you have? Who is it for?*"
- "*If you ran this birthday party twice, what would you change the second time?*"
- "*What's the cost of doing this? What's left over?*"
- "*Who would you invite who's NOT a customer?*" (i.e., not your target — surfaces segmentation thinking)

ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 4)

Quarter 1 (Reading a Business Profile) 1. *Drive past a local shop:* "What does this shop *do*, *who* do they help, and *how* do they make money?" — Follow-up: "How could you tell?" 2. *Watching TV:* "What kind of business is this commercial for?" — Follow-up: "Whats their customer?" 3. *In the news:* "Whats this story about a business?" — Follow-up: "Whats their problem?"

Quarter 2 (Reality Check + Budget) 1. *Planning anything:* "Whats your idea? Lets run the 5 questions: Who buys? How much? How many? What does it cost? Whats left?" — Follow-up: "Which question is hardest?" 2. *In the kitchen:* "If we threw a party for $50, what would the four biggest things be?" — Follow-up: "Did we add up to exactly $50?" 3. *In the car:* "How much do you think it costs to run a coffee shop for a day?" — Follow-up: "Where would the money come from?"

Quarter 3 (1-Sentence Customer Statement + 1-Page Plan) 1. *At dinner:* "Whos your customer? What do they need?" — Follow-up: "Could you say it in one sentence?" 2. *Drive-time:* "If we ran a 5-minute meeting about our weekend plans, what are the three items?" — Sample: "Last weekend, this weekend, blockers." 3. *Bedtime:* "If your business plan fit on one page, what are the five lines?" — Sample: "Idea, customer, price, costs, plan."

Quarter 4 (Real-$50-Birthday-Party Sample Dialogue)

If your child says "I want to throw a real birthday party with $50":

- **You:** "Great. Lets practice the budget first. Whats the cap?"
- **Child:** "$50."
- **You:** "What four categories?"
- **Child:** "Snacks, drinks, decorations, activity."
- **You:** "Lets put dollar amounts on each. They have to add to *exactly* $50. Go."

When the child finishes — and the budget actually adds to $50 — *then* decide as a family whether to do it for real. The budget practice happens whether or not the party does.

Sensitivity: This dialogue does *not* require the family to actually fund a $50 party. The skill is the budget; the party is optional. If your family cant or wont, the practice still happens.

ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

Cash will never say to your child: "Amazing!" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Just believe in yourself" (as substitute for evidence) / anything implying money problems are a personal failing.

Cash always asks instead: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?"

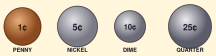
Why this matters at home. Your child will encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, some hustle-bro coded. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side: clear-eyed, honest, never selling.

One question this year: "*Did Cash ask you a question this week? What was it?*" If your child can name one, the program is landing.

FROM CASH

A plan is five honest answers

Who is it for? What is it? Why now? How much? How will I know it worked? Five lines. One page. Done.



KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 4 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Income - earning, planning, and tradeoffs.

CEE NS5
Roles of producers, consumers, and decisions.

CCSS-MATH 4.OA
Operations and algebraic thinking - model word problems.

CCSS-ELA W.4.2
Write to inform and explain - one-page plan.

CASEL Responsible Decision-Making
Identify problems, analyze situations.

C3 D2.Eco.2.3-5
Identify positive and negative incentives.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*A plan is just five honest answers in a row. Start with one.*"

- CASH, GRADE 4

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